From Trade Profits to Spendable Cash

High Trade Frequency, Low Reward-to-Risk,
and the Economics of Funded-Account Payouts

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Abstract

A high win rate is neither sufficient for positive trade expectancy nor a measure of spendable cash. We study frozen completed-minute Nasdaq futures strategies with small targets and wide stops, distinguishing source-trade profit, account survival, payout eligibility, and settled receipts. Headline totals use stress execution costs across 20 modeled accounts, each copying the two-NQ-contract source strategy. Initial and replacement accounts are assumed already funded at acquisition charges equal to 60% of evaluation list prices; evaluation passage is not modeled. Across 194 admitted sessions ending October 9, 2026, the baseline 15-point-target, 80-point-stop band-reclaim strategy produces conditional pooled net cash, after those charges, of $388,443.75 under endpoint accounting but $252,060 under a chronological minute-envelope account replay. The previously studied 20/80 alternative produces $341,910 under the same stress-cost, 20-account chronological model. Liquidations include eventual source winners; synchronized moving-block experiments expose substantial variation in cash and funding needs. The contribution is an objective and measurement framework for payout economics. Receipts and settlement are hypothetical, and unknown source sessions remain unknown.

Keywords: payout economics; first-passage risk; futures; path dependence; cash settlement; low reward-to-risk.

Evidence cutoff: October 9, 2026. **Classification:** retrospective conditional simulation, not actual payments.

1 The relevant unit of success

A trader can report many profitable trades while failing to produce a single usable withdrawal. A profitable source trade can first cross an account's loss boundary. A surviving account can fail a payout gate. An approved claim can remain in transit at the reporting cutoff. These are different outcomes, not alternative labels for the same profit number. Treating their differences as minor reporting adjustments obscures the economic object being measured.

This paper examines a particularly sharp case: repeated intraday opportunities with reward much smaller than the protective stop. Here *high trade frequency* means greater opportunity density than a sparse overnight control, not latency arbitrage, market making, or exchange-level high-frequency trading. The baseline executes 315 observed trades over 194 admitted sessions, about 1.62 per session. The information set consists of completed one-minute bars, not a fast order book.

Our contribution has three parts. First, we state the frozen signal and payoff geometry closely enough to distinguish a high target-hit probability from a positive net expectancy. Second, we

formulate the funded-account campaign as a state-dependent mapping from price paths to spendable receipts, including withdrawals, settlement, and replacements. Third, we compare existing endpoint, intratrade, and resampled campaigns on the same cash definition. The resulting rank reversals and liquidation statistics show why a source-PnL leaderboard is not a payout analysis. All comparisons retain the existing signals and parameters.

2 A frozen completed-minute signal

2.1 Information set and band construction

The worked example is the existing *band15* candidate: two NQ contracts, a 15-point target, and an 80-point stop. Prices have a 0.25-point tick; each NQ contract is worth $20 per point. All signal times below are Chicago *bar-open* times. A bar stamped t becomes available at $t+1$ minute. The regular session runs from 08:30 through 14:59; the 15:00 bar supplies the terminal opening event.

For completed bars $(O_t, H_t, L_t, C_t, V_t)$, define typical price $P_t = (H_t + L_t + C_t)/3$, session VWAP W_t, and the Wilder-style range recursion:

$$W_t = \frac{\sum_{j=08:30}^{t} V_j P_j}{\sum_{j=08:30}^{t} V_j}, \qquad A_{08:30} = H_{08:30} - L_{08:30}, \tag{1}$$

$$R_t = \max\{H_t - L_t, |H_t - C_{t-1}|, |L_t - C_{t-1}|\}, \qquad A_t = A_{t-1} + \frac{R_t - A_{t-1}}{14}, \tag{2}$$

$$b_t = \max\{8, 1.5A_t\}. \tag{3}$$

VWAP is undefined when cumulative volume is zero. Indicators reset each regular session. They require a consecutive, healthy prefix; no overnight observations are needed for this RTH-only mechanism.

After at least 30 completed RTH bars, a setup may arm from 09:00 through 14:27. Both setup and confirmation require positive volume, a bar range no greater than 40 points, defined VWAP, and a healthy prefix. A long setup has $C_t \le W_t - b_t$ and freezes the anchor $a = W_t - b_t$. A short setup has $C_t \ge W_t + b_t$ and freezes $a = W_t + b_t$. Only the immediately following completed minute can confirm:

$$\text{long:} \quad C_{t+1} \ge a, \quad C_{t+1} < W_{t+1}, \quad C_{t+1} > O_{t+1}; \tag{4}$$

$$\text{short:} \quad C_{t+1} \le a, \quad C_{t+1} > W_{t+1}, \quad C_{t+1} < O_{t+1}. \tag{5}$$

The frozen anchor matters: replacing it with the next bar's band changes the signal. Confirmation is evaluated before expiry. The setup is consumed whether confirmed, blocked, or expired, and cannot rearm on its evaluation bar. Signal bars therefore run from 09:01 through 14:28. Entry is queued for the next open, not awarded at the signal close or at an earlier excursion through the anchor.

2.2 Ownership and the comparison family

The shared engine allows one pending or open position, at most three filled entries per session, and at most two per added RTH mechanism. Thus band15 alone can fill at most twice per session. There is no pyramiding or deferred queue. After an exit in bar t, the first eligible signal observation is at $t+1+5$ minutes. A new signal on the exit bar cannot queue reentry. All signal states advance even when another component owns the position.

The original twelve-candidate family also contains EMA pullback/reclaim, opening-range failed-break, and a separate native overnight-profile control, plus their frozen combinations. Arbitration is native, EMA, band, then opening range; native roles are VAL, VPOC, then VAH. These combinations are independent alternatives, not additive portfolios. The separately completed payoff study uses the same band mechanism with targets $15, 20, 25, 30$ and stops $40, 60, 80$. Each geometry was replayed with its own occupancy and cooldown. The 20/80 comparison in this paper is that existing contender, not a target adjustment applied retrospectively to the baseline trade list.

3 Small rewards, large losses, and execution costs

Let $q = 2$, $v = 20$ dollars per point, target T, stop S, and roundtrip commission $f = 12$ dollars. For a non-gap bracket outcome, adverse stop slippage s points gives net target profit G and absolute stop loss L:

$$G = qvT - f, \qquad L = qv(S + s) + f, \qquad \mathbb{E}[X] = pG - (1 - p)L, \qquad p_{\mathrm{BE}} = \frac{L}{G + L}. \tag{6}$$

Base costs use one tick on market entry, stop, and timed exit; stress uses two. Targets fill at the target without favorable improvement. Crucially, brackets are anchored to the *slipped entry*. Entry slippage changes the price level and potentially the outcome, but is not subtracted a second time from a target whose distance is defined from that fill. The fee is \$3 per contract per side.

Table 1: Frozen low-reward geometries: binary, non-gap arithmetic, not an empirical forecast.

TP/SL	Gross reward/risk	Net target	Net stop B/S	Break-even B/S
13/80	0.1625	\$508	\$3,222 / \$3,232	86.38% / 86.42%
15/80	0.1875	\$588	\$3,222 / \$3,232	84.57% / 84.61%
20/80	0.2500	\$788	\$3,222 / \$3,232	80.35% / 80.40%

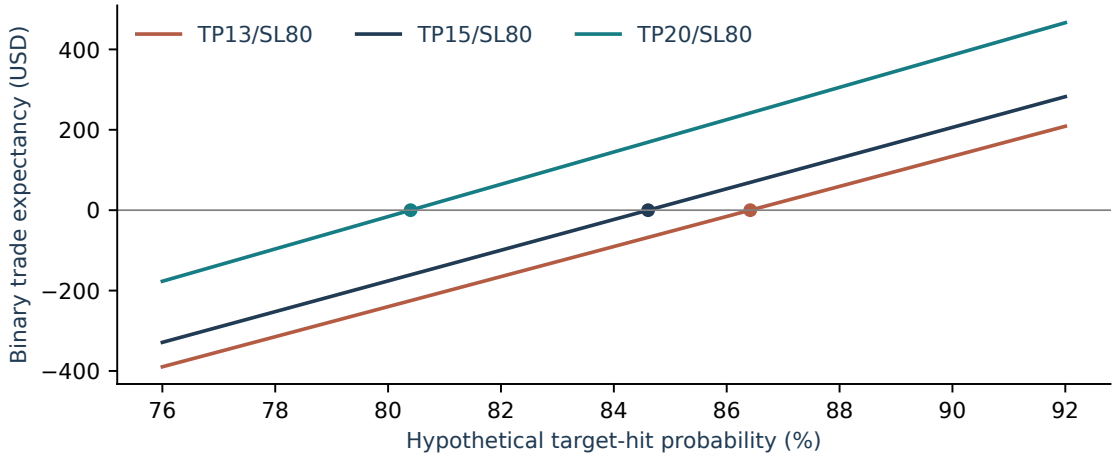


Figure 1: Stress-cost binary expectancy. Dots mark break-even target-hit probabilities. The chart varies a mathematical probability, not the strategy parameters or an estimated account-survival probability.

A stress stop consumes approximately 5.50 baseline target wins. The condition "win rate above 80%" is therefore weak evidence for a 15/80 strategy. Moreover, Equation (6) is not the full empirical payoff distribution: timed exits, gap stops, and account liquidations need not equal either endpoint.

Through October 9 the baseline stress source has an 83.49% resolved win rate, $21,150 resolved net, and profit factor 1.158. Its positive subtotal below the binary break-even rate is not an algebraic contradiction; the realized losers are not all full-stop losses. The 20/80 source has 313 resolved trades, an 80.51% win rate, $40,874 net, and profit factor 1.260. Both retain four unknown sessions, so these are observed subtotals, not complete-population estimates.

Fill ordering remains conservative. An adverse gap through the stop fills at the open with adverse slippage. An already-resting target penetrated by at least one tick at the open fills at the target before a due timer or later range. Otherwise a due timer precedes intrabar processing; a stop touch precedes a same-bar target penetration. RTH positions time out after 60 minutes, capped at 15:00. A missing due-entry bar cancels rather than fills late. Missing held paths retain unresolved ownership; neither end-of-file nor a gap invents a profitable liquidation.

4 A cash objective and an account state machine

For account a, let E_t^a be trading equity relative to funded start, F_t^a the loss floor, H_t^a the relevant high-water mark, D_t^a qualifying-day state, and Q_t^a a collection of unsettled claims. Add position ownership, new-profit counters, request clocks, generation number, and replacement-ready time. The resulting state Z_t^a is necessary because the same next trade can produce different cash outcomes at different points in the campaign.

Let w_j be an eligible gross withdrawal, α_a the trader split, u_j the time it becomes usable, and k_i an acquisition charge at time b_i. Conditional personal cash through cutoff τ is

$$C_\tau = \sum_{a,j} \alpha_a w_j \, \mathbf{1}\{u_j \le \tau, \text{claim survives}\} - \sum_i k_i \, \mathbf{1}\{b_i \le \tau\}. \tag{7}$$

No account equity, pending claim, or terminal balance is added back. Costs here are acquisition costs external to the account; trade fees already reduce account equity. The cash objective is $\max_\pi \mathbb{E}[C_\tau(\pi)]$ over admissible campaign policies, not $\max \sum X_i$ over unconstrained source trades. We evaluate existing policies rather than solve this optimization anew.

The state sequence is funded and eligible, trading, payout-eligible, requested, approved, provider transfer, bank settlement, usable cash. A hard breach ends the account generation; replacement purchase and readiness begin another. A daily-limit liquidation need not equal a permanent hard breach. The account may be parked by a pending claim without releasing source-strategy ownership. At a withdrawal debit, E_t^a falls by the gross debit under the frozen policy. The next trade consequently begins with different headroom $B_t^a = E_t^a - F_t^a$. Withdrawal is thus simultaneously a cash opportunity and a change in future survival capacity, as in dividend-versus-ruin problems [2, 3].

All four modeled splits are 90%. Floors initially sit $2,000 below funded start; their caps are $100 for MFFU, Lucid, and Tradeify, and zero for Topstep. A plan's EOD name does not make every funded risk check EOD-only: Lucid's funded trail is intraday. Holding/conduct, scaling, request/debit, and claim-survival rules remain distinct; the table is not a replacement for those gates. Later rule captures are applied as historical counterfactuals, not represented as the terms a customer actually held in January.

Table 2: Principal frozen funded-plan distinctions. Dollar figures are per account; these are modeled rules, not verified historical customer terms.

Plan	Risk floor	Principal withdrawal gate	Paid acquisition
MFFU Rapid EOD	EOD trail; \$2,000 distance	\$2,100 retained buffer assumed; \$500 minimum and subsequent profit; daily wait	\$135
Lucid Daily	Funded intraday trail; \$2,000 distance	\$2,100 buffer; \$500 minimum; positive new profit	\$99.60
Tradeify Daily	EOD trail plus independent \$1,000 daily limit	\$250 minimum; \$1,250 cap; twice requested amount in new profit	\$99
Topstep Standard	EOD trail; locks at zero	Five \$150 winning days; 50% withdrawal fraction; \$2,000 cap	\$57

5 From price history to a financed campaign

5.1 Four ledgers that must not be collapsed

The source ledger answers which signals filled under the frozen minute audit. The account ledger answers which portions of those trades each account could hold before its own boundary. The claim ledger answers when a withdrawal is eligible, debited, disputed, or settled. The personal wallet answers when receipts can actually finance acquisitions within the model. Denote this composition by

$$\{\text{bars}\} \longmapsto \{\text{source paths}\} \longmapsto \{Z_t^a\}_a \longmapsto \{\text{claims}\} \longmapsto C_t. \tag{8}$$

Replacing source paths by their final PnL before applying account risk does not commute with this composition. If $\tau_F = \inf\{t : E_t \le F_t\}$ precedes the source target, the account outcome stops at τ_F even when the eventual source outcome is positive. Equality conventions remain plan-specific. Once an account fails, continuing its hypothetical recovery would contaminate both its survival statistics and every later payout.

The endpoint scenario feeds only entry and exit marks into the account kernels. The chronological scenario instead uses a declared source-bracket-clipped minute envelope: entry, open, favorable mark, adverse mark, close, with terminal handling that excludes movement after the modeled source exit. Favorable before adverse exposes intraday trailing-floor risk but is not an observed tick order. A breach fills at the first crossing vertex, not at an interpolated threshold; overshoot is possible. Full commission is reserved once at entry. Native liquidation adds \$10 base or \$20 stress per two-contract account beyond the already-costed source execution.

5.2 Wallet, availability, and account copies

Daily15 contains five MFFU, five Lucid, and five Tradeify accounts. Topstep5 is separate. Pooled20 is their combined *cash wallet*, not pooled equity, loss limits, or buying power. Each firm lane has five synchronous copies; five copies do not constitute five independent observations. The overlapping Common15 comparison elsewhere in the evidence must not be added to Pooled20.

The campaign starts funded and charges one evaluation at 60% of list for each acquired account. Initial costs are \$1,668 for Daily15 and \$285 for Topstep5. Replacements become ready seven New

York calendar days after purchase; Tradeify purchase quotas can delay that clock. No evaluation-pass process is simulated. Settlement assumes one calendar day to approval, one to provider transfer, and two to bank settlement. Pending-at-open parks the full session. These calendar-second lags are not bank-business-day service guarantees.

With receipts recycled, the minimum modeled initial wallet is

$$K_{\min} = \max\{0, -\min_{t \le \tau} C_t\}. \tag{9}$$

This is a chronological deficit calculation under external financing, not an affordability-constrained policy or a recommended launch budget. Failed-account trading losses are not charged again to the trader's wallet: the model places those losses in account equity and charges replacement acquisition separately. That limited-liability/access assumption is economically decisive. The large cash totals below are not a conventional investment return on the small initial purchase price, nor evidence that unlimited cheap funded replacements exist.

6 Endpoint cash: the complete original family

Table 3 retains all twelve original candidates in their frozen order. It compares usable receipts after firm split and acquisition charges, not the source's hypothetical trading balance. Base and stress are alternatives, not quantities to sum. The period is January 1–October 9, 2026: 194 admitted regular sessions, not a full observed calendar year.

Table 3: Conditional endpoint-model net personal cash (USD). B/S denote base/stress. Daily15 and Pooled20 overlap and must not be added.

Candidate	Daily15 B	Daily15 S	Pooled20 B	Pooled20 S
native13	148,476	148,476	201,054	201,054
ema13	98,166	50,334	128,973	66,225
ema15	101,388	102,432	147,102	140,877
band13	173,415	173,235	247,618.50	223,725.75
band15	310,755	310,485	389,152.50	388,443.75
or13	204,726	204,726	262,095	262,050
or15	181,170	181,170	252,159	252,024
native_ema13	155,997	155,151	199,800	200,610
native_band13	236,697	237,435	297,357	316,806
native_or13	264,780	264,780	346,537.50	346,515
native_all13	309,300	170,379	374,388	204,684
native_all15	250,203	207,411	346,353	303,561

Band15 leads both displayed groups in both cost cases within this original family. Yet more entries are not inherently better: native-all13 pooled cash falls from $374,388 to $204,684 under stress, a $169,704 difference. Its combination of frequent small wins, occasional large losses, and account-state thresholds magnifies modest execution changes. Conversely, native-band13 has higher stress than base cash. This does not establish that worse execution is beneficial; changed failures and replacement dates alter which subsequent opportunities the accounts can trade. "Stress" denotes the declared cost case, not a global lower bound on campaign cash.

For baseline stress, Pooled20 receives $413,520.75 after firm splits. Initial acquisition costs $1,953 and replacements cost $23,124, leaving $388,443.75. The 235 replacement acquisitions are additional to the original 20 accounts. There are 415 individual-account payouts in 83 synchronous withdrawal

batches; $15,876 of pending claims is excluded. Continued account access is therefore not a small ancillary assumption: it is a repeated input to the reported outcome.

Settlement timing also matters. The endpoint baseline has 42 distinct pooled receipt dates; the largest five supply 21.70% of usable receipts. Its longest no-receipt interval is 22 civil days. Topstep5 has only 11 receipt dates, a 55.10% top-five concentration, and a 60-day drought. The wallet can smooth firm-specific settlement timing without diversifying the common source signal. Positive total cash is not equivalent to regular income.

These results do not rehabilitate the original signal-screen qualification. At the earlier October 1 research cutoff, none of the twelve candidates met all frozen qualifiers; the confirmation interval was already explored, not pristine out-of-sample evidence. Cash is a different economic measure, not a reason to relabel an unsuccessful qualification or erase missing sessions.

7 Propagating intratrade failures changes the answer

The existing twelve-geometry payoff study found endpoint stress Pooled20 cash of $425,814 for 20/80, compared with $388,443.75 for the 15/80 baseline. That $37,370.25 advantage came from Topstep5: Daily15 instead fell from $310,485 to $292,809. The chronological replay revisits both alternatives without changing their signals, brackets, or account rules.

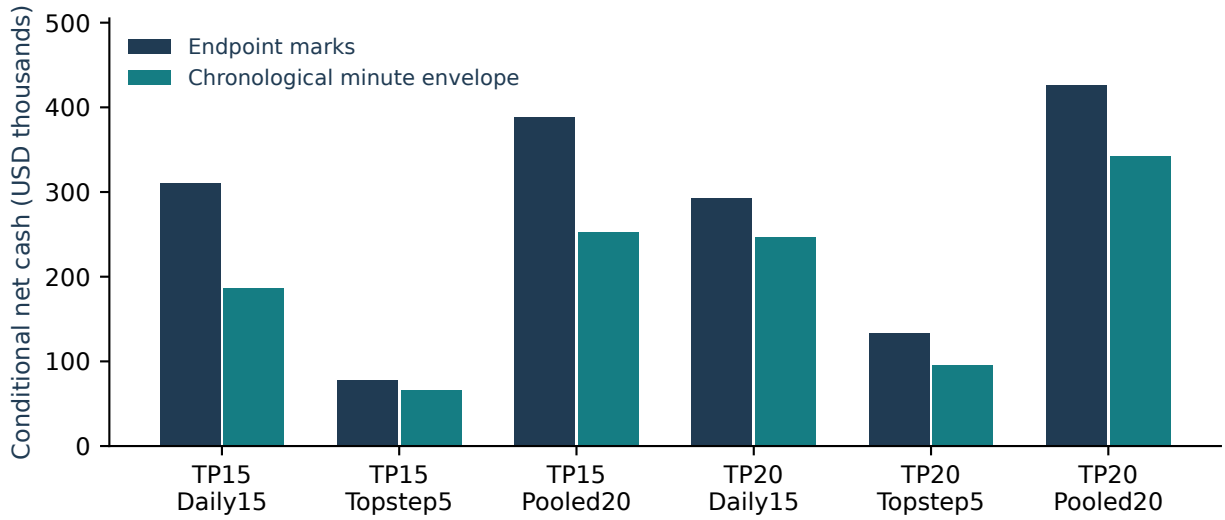


Figure 2: Endpoint versus chronological minute-envelope net cash, stress costs. Each bar is a complete conditional campaign. Pooled20 contains the other two groups; it is not an additional allocation.

Baseline Pooled20 falls by $136,383.75, or 35.1%, to $252,060. The 20/80 alternative falls by $83,904, or 19.7%, to $341,910. These are not blanket haircuts to endpoint receipts. Earlier failures change generations, readiness, participation, claims, and all subsequent withdrawals. Subtracting receipts "exposed" to a missed breach without replaying those transitions would produce neither campaign.

The Daily15 ordering also reverses: 20/80 now exceeds baseline by $60,135, while the Pooled20 advantage is $89,850. This illustrates a dependence of the cash ranking on the path model as well as on the firm mix. It is not evidence of a newly discovered optimum: both alternatives come from previously explored history rather than an untouched validation sample.

The chronological baseline requires $3,906 minimum modeled pooled starting cash; 20/80 requires

Table 4: Chronological stress cash accounting, USD. The final column compares with the corresponding endpoint campaign, not with actual payments.

TP/SL	Group	Receipts	Costs	Net cash	Δ endpoint
15/80	Daily15	215,541	29,346	186,195	-124,290
15/80	Topstep5	70,425	4,560	65,865	-12,093.75
15/80	Pooled20	285,966	33,906	252,060	-136,383.75
20/80	Daily15	275,859	29,529	246,330	-46,479
20/80	Topstep5	99,000	3,420	95,580	-37,425
20/80	Pooled20	374,859	32,949	341,910	-83,904

$5,364. Higher final cash can coexist with a larger early funding deficit. Pending claims are zero for these chronological campaigns at the cutoff, unlike the endpoint baseline. Source-unknown dates and their later campaign dependence remain attached to both results. The chronological model is more informative about this ordering scenario, not quote-exact or a universal upper/lower bound on the cash a real account could receive.

8 Survival is account-specific, not a stop-distance label

For an account-owned trade ending at its own liquidation or source exit τ_a, define commission-inclusive adverse excursion and minimum headroom:

$$M_a = \max_{t \le \tau_a} \{ f - qv\, d(p_t - P_{\text{entry}}) \}, \qquad h_a = \min_{t \le \tau_a} \{ E_t^a - F_t^a \}, \tag{10}$$

where p_t is an account-path price mark and $d \in \{-1, 1\}$ is direction. The daily-limit margin is tracked separately. A static comparison of M_a with $2,000 ignores profits retained after prior withdrawals, floor locks, intraday ratchets, and the daily opening-equity anchor.

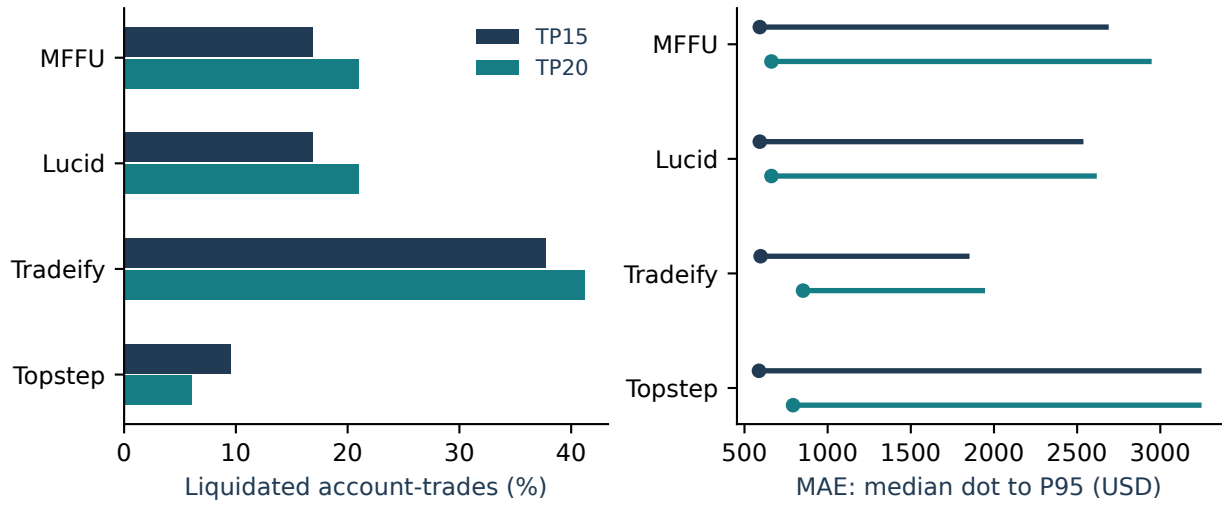


Figure 3: Stress account-trade liquidation shares and adverse-excursion distributions. MAE includes commission; dots are medians and line ends are P95s. Each lane is one representative of five synchronous copies, not five independent samples.

Tradeify liquidates 43 of 114 baseline account-trades, including 23 eventual source winners. Eighteen are hard breaches and 25 are daily-limit-only liquidations. Thus an 83.49% source win

Table 5: Stress survival diagnostics, per representative two-contract account. "Winners liq." counts eventual source winners that the account could not hold.

TP/SL	Firm	Trades	Liq.	Winners liq.	Surv. > 3k	P95 MAE
15/80	Mffu	95	16	3	0	2,674
15/80	Lucid	95	16	3	0	2,522
15/80	Tradeify	114	43	23	0	1,837
15/80	Topstep	158	15	5	11	3,232
20/80	Mffu	81	17	2	0	2,932
20/80	Lucid	81	17	3	0	2,602
20/80	Tradeify	97	40	19	0	1,930
20/80	Topstep	181	11	2	24	3,232

rate cannot stand in for account survival or payout probability. The account's effective protection can be far tighter than the source's $3,200 gross stop.

Conversely, a large excursion is not automatically fatal. On September 22, a baseline Topstep stress account begins $3,292 above its zero floor, incurs $3,012 commission-inclusive MAE, retains $280 headroom, and finishes $588 ahead. Eleven baseline Topstep trades survive more than $3,000 adverse movement; one ends profitable. The analogous 20/80 counts are 24 and three. An arbitrary $2,000 excursion filter would misclassify these paths.

Across both targets and costs, the existing analysis contains 1,809 representative account-trades and 349 liquidations. Of those liquidation paths, 341 end before the final source vertex and eight at it. Excursion measurement stops at account exit: subsequent source recovery is excluded. Headroom is measured before the additional liquidation penalty; crossing-vertex overshoot can make buffer utilization exceed 100%. These are distributions under the declared envelope, not measured intratick survival probabilities.

9 Dependence, cash tails, and receipt droughts

The completed experiment resamples noncircular moving blocks of five and ten sessions, with seed 20261010 and 32 draws per block length. One source-index vector is shared by all four target/cost alternatives and all firms. Complete ordered source paths are placed on the actual target calendar with New York and daylight-saving remapping; each campaign reruns risk, replacements, claims, and settlement. It does not bootstrap already-computed payout totals. There are 64 synchronized draws and 256 alternative-specific components, not 256 independent trials.

Table 6: Pooled stress cash, USD. Worst-3 mean averages the three smallest of 32 draws, not an exact fractional 10% expected-shortfall estimate.

TP/SL	Block	P5	Median	P95	Worst-3 mean	Losses
15/80	5	26,135.03	168,243.75	328,259.92	10,697.50	1/32
15/80	10	73,871.70	176,470.50	294,722.40	70,371	0/32
20/80	5	98,390.55	251,954.25	451,166.70	80,964	0/32
20/80	10	167,983.05	297,439.50	400,375.20	151,618	0/32

Baseline five-session-block median cash is $168,243.75, well below its $252,060 chronological historical result. Its worst-three mean is only $10,697.50, with one net-loss draw. Ten-session blocks produce a different lower tail; choosing the more flattering length would defeat this sensitivity exercise. Keeping local dependence is preferable to treating every trade as independent, but block

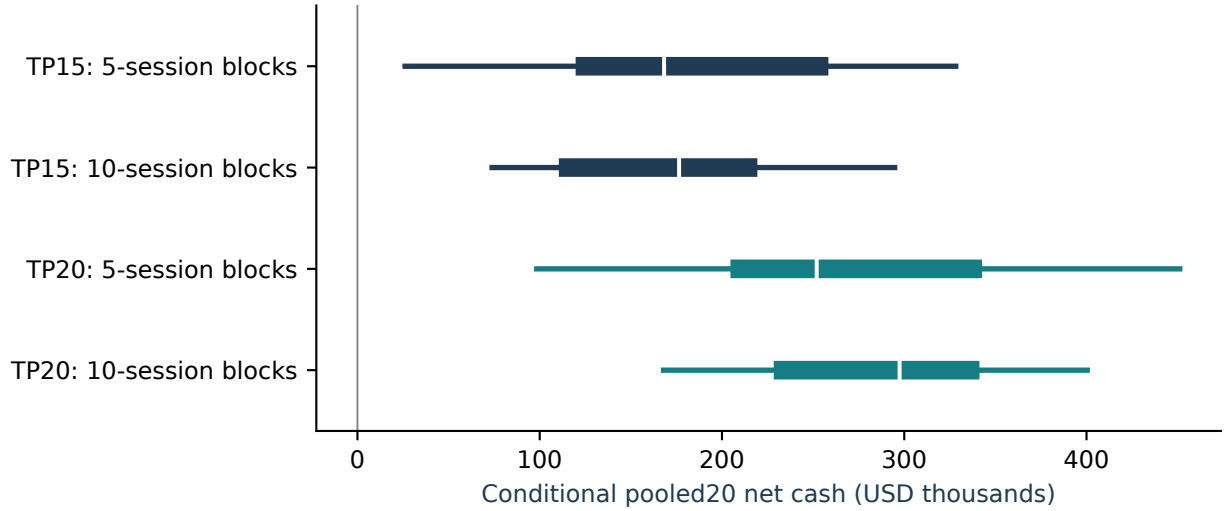


Figure 4: Pooled stress net-cash distributions. Thin lines span P5–P95, thick segments P25–P75, and white marks the medians. These are descriptive 32-draw distributions, not confidence intervals.

boundaries still discard longer dependence [4]. No resampling procedure here manufactures an unseen regime.

Cash tails and liquidity tails answer different questions. Baseline pooled P95 required seed funding is $12,555.60 for five-session blocks and $13,337.10 for ten-session blocks. P95 longest receipt droughts are 106.35 and 82.57 calendar days, including boundary-censored intervals. For 20/80, P95 funding is $9,503.70/$10,950.75 and drought is 82.23/81.57 days. These are separate marginal quantiles, not one joint worst-case draw or a sufficient funding recommendation.

Zero losses in 32 draws is not zero risk: empirical probability resolution is 3.125 percentage points. Unknown sampled sessions retain null daily outcomes; even draws omitting them inherit an incomplete source-pool disclosure. Access, settlement, minute ordering, and externally financed replacement remain fixed assumptions throughout. The experiment measures retrospective sensitivity, not a calibrated probability of future payout success.

10 Fixed-cutoff recency and unknown-safe measurement

All three windows are fixed before looking at their economics: the last 5, 10, and 30 admitted sessions ending October 9. Membership follows the admitted calendar, never an optimization over dates. Capital, account generations, and claims are not restarted at a window boundary. Cash spans the previous admitted session's 17:00 New York cutoff, exclusive, through the package cutoff, inclusive. Weekend settlements therefore remain included.

Table 7: Fixed-window stress diagnostics. Source counts, WR, and PnL refer to the single Q2 baseline. Cash columns refer to Pooled20: endpoint baseline, chronological baseline, and chronological 20/80. All dollar figures are USD.

Window	Trades	WR	Source net	Endpt. 15	Path 15	Path 20
L5	8	75.0%	-2,936	-285	7,827	-1,173
L10	18	77.8%	-3,436	40,467	6,159	-3,126
L30	52	80.8%	76	96,606	41,400	50,847

A zero-receipt window is not a zero source-PnL window. For example, endpoint baseline L5 has zero usable receipts but $285 acquisition cost, hence −$285 net cash; chronological baseline has $7,827. Previously earned claims can settle during a weak trading interval, just as recent profitable trades may not yet be eligible or settled. Recency cannot resolve the objective by replacing settled cash with current trading profit.

The public aggregate companions preserve all source and account metrics: source, accepted, resolved, and censored counts; resolved subtotal versus complete-known-day PnL; both EV denominators; gross profit, gross loss, and profit-factor support; unknown-reset known-segment drawdown; green, red, zero, and unknown counts and full-window shares; wins, losses, zero trades, win-rate support; and best complete-known day with its contribution share. Win rate is wins divided by wins plus losses. Profit factor is undefined without profit or loss, and positive infinity with profit but no loss; these cases are reported distinctly. EV and win rate remain unestimated when their denominators are zero.

An admitted unknown session remains unobserved, never a no-trade zero or a bridge in the drawdown path. Baseline full-history unknown dates are March 16, March 20, April 10, and June 18. Native-containing candidates additionally retain January 6, March 17–19, April 21, June 16–17, and September 15. Thus native L30 retains September 15 as unknown although RTH-only L30 is known. Earlier uncertainty continues to qualify later campaign cash even when the recent source window is complete. Best-day contribution may exceed one or be negative; it is not a stability score.

Exact admitted-session membership

L5: 2026-10-05, 2026-10-06, 2026-10-07, 2026-10-08, 2026-10-09.

L10: 2026-09-28, 2026-09-29, 2026-09-30, 2026-10-01, 2026-10-02, 2026-10-05, 2026-10-06, 2026-10-07, 2026-10-08, 2026-10-09.

L30: 2026-08-28, 2026-08-31, 2026-09-01, 2026-09-02, 2026-09-03, 2026-09-04, 2026-09-08, 2026-09-09, 2026-09-10, 2026-09-11, 2026-09-14, 2026-09-15, 2026-09-16, 2026-09-17, 2026-09-18, 2026-09-21, 2026-09-22, 2026-09-23, 2026-09-24, 2026-09-25, 2026-09-28, 2026-09-29, 2026-09-30, 2026-10-01, 2026-10-02, 2026-10-05, 2026-10-06, 2026-10-07, 2026-10-08, 2026-10-09.

The companion files retain every daily aggregate within these windows and all alternatives, not just the displayed baseline. No private trade rows, account identifiers, order timestamps, or vendor bars are released. Recent performance is descriptive, not a selection criterion.

11 Interpretation, limitations, and conclusion

11.1 What the cash objective changes

The principal distinction is between generating gains and converting a state-dependent claim into usable money. Low reward-to-risk can generate frequent qualifying wins, but it also concentrates losses into rare large events. Whether that tradeoff helps a funded-account campaign depends on *when* adverse excursions occur, what floor is then binding, which withdrawals have reduced the buffer, and when replacements and receipts become available. Frequency, win rate, and headline PnL are therefore intermediate statistics, not the final objective.

For the frozen baseline, chronological stress net cash is roughly $136,384 below the endpoint result. Liquidation of eventual winners explains why terminal trade labels are insufficient. The already-tested 20/80 alternative has lower source win rate but higher chronological cash. Neither observation establishes a general preference for wide stops or a deployable optimum. Optimization

over previously explored alternatives invites selection bias; reporting the full family and fixed recency windows makes that limitation visible but does not remove it [5, 6].

11.2 The boundary of the evidence

Three assumptions dominate economic interpretation. First, OHLCV bars do not reveal intraminute ordering, executable depth, queue priority, or real fills [7]. The envelope is a declared scenario, not a reconstruction of those facts. Second, cheap access to already-funded replacement accounts, continued simulated-account access, copy permissions, and honored claims are assumed. Five MFFU accounts are a scenario-specific access assumption. Third, settlement and acquisition prices are hypothetical; taxes, financing interest, platform/data charges, and unresolved ancillary fees are not independently measured. Actual receipts have not been verified; missing observations are not measured zeros.

The practical conclusion is methodological: evaluate a frozen signal through separate path, account, claim, and wallet layers before discussing cash-out performance. Report the dependence of that answer on survival and settlement, not merely the most attractive number. The existing evidence supports this accounting argument. It does not establish untouched forward performance, TradingView fill parity, or actual payout reliability.

Data and materials. Numerical results derive from Bhav Jain's completed NQ frequency payout-cash, payoff-and-buffer, and chronological path-cash studies (October 2026). The accompanying materials archive [1] provides the manuscript, vector figures, aggregate comparison and fixed-window tables, and exact source references. Private trade records and vendor market data are excluded.

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